

Carton barcode format — EAN-128 vs EAN-13

How to choose the barcode symbology for a **carton-marking** output — EAN-128 (Code 128) or EAN-13 — and set its bar height. A per-output setting in the Prod Spec editor.

Admins only · set under **Prod specs** ▶ open a spec ▶ a **Carton marking** output. It changes only the **carton** (outer-box) barcode — never the per-size product EANs.

1 What it controls

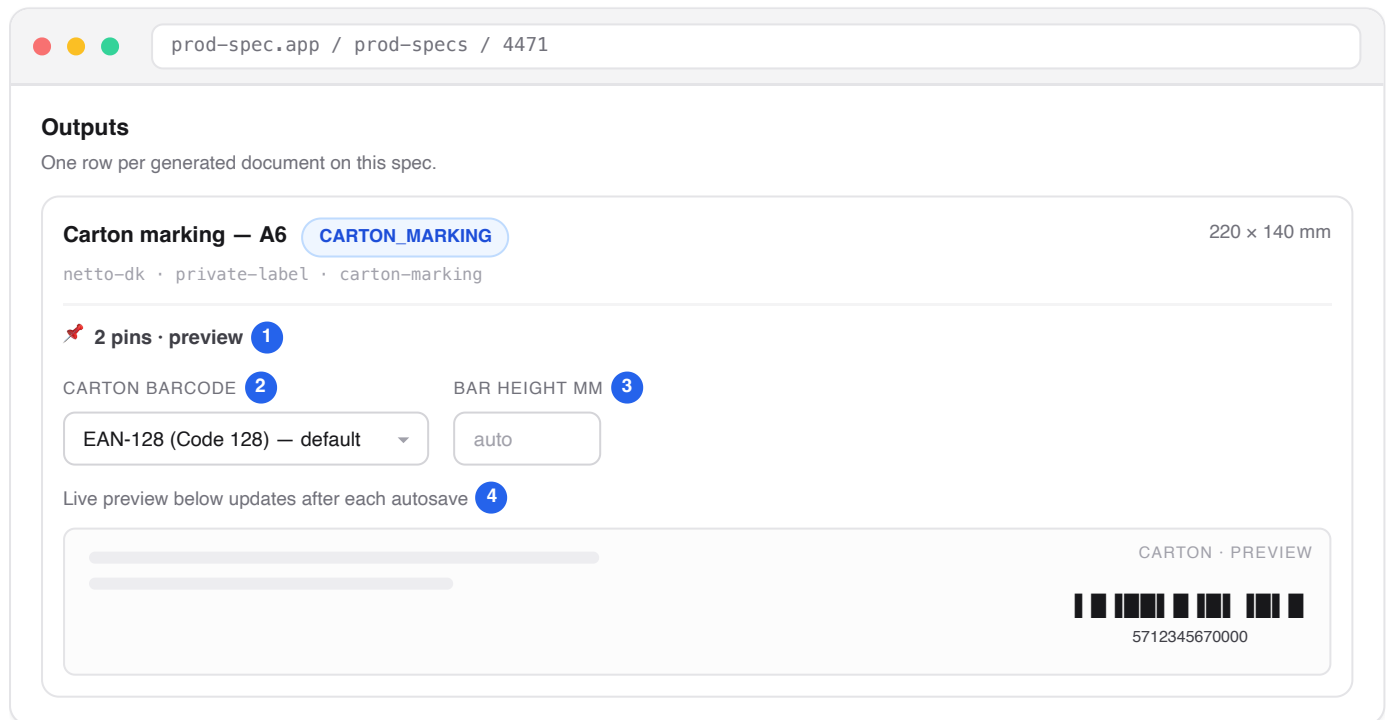
Carton-marking labels carry the **carton EAN** (the outer box's number). This setting decides how that number prints — as **EAN-128 / Code 128** bars with the digits beneath (the default), or as a true **EAN-13** retail symbol. It's set **per output**, so two carton outputs on the same spec can differ.

It only touches the carton barcode

The per-size **product** EAN-13s on care labels, price stickers and the like are always true EAN-13 and are **not** affected. This switch is exclusively the carton/outer-box barcode (`{{barcode:cartonEan}}` in builder layouts, and the carton-marking templates).

2 Where to find it

Open the spec, find the **carton-marking** output, expand its  **... · preview** panel — the **Carton barcode** dropdown sits at the top, next to **Bar height mm**.



The screenshot shows a web application interface for editing a product specification. At the top, there's a breadcrumb trail: 'prod-spec.app / prod-specs / 4471'. Below this, the 'Outputs' section is active, showing 'One row per generated document on this spec.' The main configuration area is for 'Carton marking — A6' (220 x 140 mm). It includes a breadcrumb 'netto-dk · private-label · carton-marking'. A '2 pins · preview' button is visible. The configuration has two main sections: 'CARTON BARCODE' (labeled 2) with a dropdown menu currently set to 'EAN-128 (Code 128) — default', and 'BAR HEIGHT MM' (labeled 3) with a text input set to 'auto'. A note below these says 'Live preview below updates after each autosave' (labeled 4). At the bottom right, there's a 'CARTON · PREVIEW' section showing a barcode and the number '5712345670000'.

- 1 **It lives inside the collapsed “ ... · preview” panel.** If you don't expand the output row you won't see it — that's the usual reason people can't find it.
- 2 **Carton barcode** — the symbology dropdown. Two choices: **EAN-128 (Code 128) — default** and **EAN-13**. Leaving it on the default stores nothing (absent = EAN-128).
- 3 **Bar height mm** — optional override for how tall the bars print. Blank = **auto** (16 mm on the coded templates; scaled to the block in Output Builder). Range 4–60 mm.
- 4 **The preview wears the setting.** What you see here is what the generated PDF prints — change the dropdown and the carton barcode re-renders after the autosave.

The dropdown only appears on carton-marking outputs

It's shown solely for outputs whose document type is **CARTON_MARKING**. On a care label, price sticker or any other output the control is hidden — there's no carton barcode to switch there.

3 The two formats

Pick the one the customer's carton spec asks for. When unsure, leave it on the default — EAN-128 is the historic carton marking.

Default EAN-128 (Code 128)	Alt EAN-13
• Carton EAN encoded as Code 128 bars, with the number printed beneath the bars. • The historic carton-marking look — use it for most master-carton labels. • Handles the full carton number cleanly; not a retail till symbol. • Stored as nothing — it's what you get when the setting is left alone.	• Carton EAN printed as a true EAN-13 retail symbol, digits inside the guard bars. • Use when the carton must carry the same scannable EAN-13 as the product. • Requires a valid 13-digit EAN — a non-EAN number won't encode. • Chosen explicitly from the dropdown; stored on the output.

Good to know

“EAN-128” here is plain **Code 128** of the carton number — not GS1-128 with application identifiers (the (00)/SSCC style). If a customer ever needs true GS1-128, that's a dev change, not this dropdown.

4 Where the setting takes effect

Save and it applies everywhere that carton output is rendered — the in-editor preview, the downloadable PDF, and every future generation of that output. Both rendering paths honour it.

- 1 **Set it on the output** in the Prod Spec editor (per carton-marking output).
- 2 **It's applied at render time** to the carton barcode — the coded carton-marking templates and Output Builder carton layouts both read it.
- 3 **Preview and final PDF match** — the live preview and the generated document use the same setting, so what you approve is what prints.

In one line: Prod specs ▶ open the spec ▶ expand a **Carton marking** output's  **preview** panel ▶ set **Carton barcode** to EAN-128 (default) or EAN-13, and optionally **Bar height**. It changes only the carton barcode, per output.